even uncover hoards of black money or prevent its re-emergence,' Patel added, '*All that it would do for certain would be to inflict a great deal of hardship on a great many innocent people and to increase corruption immensely.*'

It is, therefore, not clear why the Finance Minister agreed to the 1978 demonetization. Defending the move after its completion, however, he refuted the idea that the move could harm trade and industry saying demonetization '…would affect smugglers who were in any case on the fringes of trade and industry.' He also declared he was pleased. *The Times of India* quoted him as saying somewhat cryptically, 'You will see me smiling whatever the result!' Such are the mystifying compulsions of politics!

The value of high denomination notes in circulation on 17 January 1978 was estimated at about ₹180 crore. Of these, notes worth ₹20 crore or 11.1 per cent were not submitted for exchange and therefore extinguished. Like the preceding demonetization of 1946, the note ban of 1978 had no discernible impact on either black money or corruption.

The ₹500 note was once again reintroduced in October 1987–88, while the ₹1,000 notes were reintroduced in November 2000, both with the portrait of Mahatma Gandhi and a watermark of the Lion Capital of Sarnath.

In an interesting side note, it was Yashwant Sinha, then Finance Minister in the Atal Bihari Vajpayee-led NDA government, who introduced the High Denomination Bank Notes (Demonetisation) Amendment Bill, in December 1998 to reintroduce ₹1,000 notes. Addressing the Parliament, he said, 'The Congress Party Government under Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao had proposed this in 1994, and that the United Front government had also 'decided to go ahead' but "political events intervened and they could not bring the Bill before this House". However, looking at the justification and